

UNIT 1 · LESSON 4

My Inside Voice — Kind or

Unkind?

20–25 min · Week 4

OBJECTIVE Students identify the difference between a Kind Coach and a Grumpy Gus inner voice, and practise replacing unkind self-talk.

CASEL FOCUS Self-Awareness · recognising self-talk; Self-Management: regulating internal narrative

VOCABULARY inside voice · Kind Coach · Grumpy Gus · self-talk · kind · unkind

MATERIALS Sammy puppet (with TWO voices ready) · Kind Coach / Grumpy Gus anchor chart paper · red and green markers

ILLINOIS SEL ALIGNMENT GRADES K-2 · EARLY ELEMENTARY

Goal 1 — Self-Awareness & Self-Management

1A.1a Recognize and accurately label emotions and how they are linked to behavior.

1A.1b Demonstrate control of impulsive behavior.

Aligned to the Illinois Social/Emotional Learning Standards (ISBE).

OPENING REVIEW · 1 – 2 MIN

Show the Mistake Wall. "Last lesson: mistakes are normal. Today: when we make a mistake, what does our inside voice say?" Two student responses.

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I have TWO voices that talk inside my head. One is kind. One is grumpy. Today we are going to meet them both."

► DIRECT INSTRUCTION

Scripted teaching sequence · 5 STEPS · read aloud or in your own words

01 Meet Kind Coach

4 MIN

Sammy speaks in his Kind Coach voice (warm, gentle): "When I make a mistake, my Kind Coach says — 'Oops! What can I learn? Let's try again.' Kind Coach is honest AND kind. Kind Coach helps me grow."

02 Meet Grumpy Gus

4 MIN

Sammy switches to Grumpy Gus voice (sharper, theatrical, never frightening): "Grumpy Gus says — 'You ALWAYS mess up! You're BAD! You'll NEVER get it right!' Grumpy Gus attacks WHO YOU ARE — not just what happened. Grumpy Gus makes us want to hide."

03 Sort the Statements

8 MIN

Read 6–8 statements. Class sorts each into Kind Coach (green) or Grumpy Gus (red). Examples: "I made a mistake — I can fix it." (Kind) / "I always ruin everything." (Grumpy) / "What can I learn from this?" (Kind) / "Nobody likes me." (Grumpy). Add to anchor chart as you go.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the sort: any child who consistently sides with Grumpy Gus statements ("but they're true though") may be carrying heavy self-talk. Note for follow-up. Do not correct in front of peers.

04 Practice Switching

5 MIN

Teacher reads a Grumpy Gus statement. Class together flips it to Kind Coach. "I always mess up" becomes "I made a mistake — I can try again." Repeat three times with different statements.

05 The Three Questions

3 MIN

Land the closer: "When something goes wrong, the Kind Coach asks three questions. ONE: What happened? TWO: What can I learn? THREE: What is one next step?" Repeat together.

Use exaggerated voice contrast. Sort with hand signals — thumbs up for Kind Coach, thumbs down for Grumpy Gus. The takeaway: Grumpy Gus is the unkind voice; Kind Coach is the helpful one.

Students write one Grumpy Gus statement they've heard themselves say (anonymous, on a slip), then write the Kind Coach version. Pair-share before whole-group.

EXIT TICKET

"Show me with your fingers: how many voices live inside your head? (Hold up two.) Which one are you going to listen to?"

Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students could not generate a Kind Coach reframe? Which seemed surprised the kind voice was even an option? These students need extra support before Unit 2.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Any student whose Grumpy Gus statements felt unusually harsh or specific to their identity — note for counselor awareness. Do not press publicly.

Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up? ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

A Note Home

Today we learned about two inside voices: Kind Coach and Grumpy Gus. At home, when you hear your child being hard on themselves, ask gently: "Was that your Kind Coach or your Grumpy Gus?"

A N C H O R C H A R T · U N I T 1 · L E S S O N 4

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

ANCHOR CHART · CLASSROOM DISPLAY — PRINT ON CARDSTOCK OR 11×17, POST AS THE LESSON INDICATES

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE · BOOK 1 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

My Inside Voice

Kind Coach or Grumpy Gus?

SELF-COMPASSION

GRUMPY GUS

- “I always mess up.”
- “I can’t do this.”
- Loud — but not true

KIND COACH

- “I made a mistake — I can try again.”
- “This is hard. I can keep going.”
- Honest — and kind

We can always flip Grumpy Gus into the Kind Coach: What happened? · What can I learn? · What is one next step?

THE ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE FOUNDATION · CONFIDENTIAL — FOR DISTRICT REVIEW ONLY

Kind Coach vs. Grumpy Gus

Permanent Anchor — Reference Every Lesson

× GRUMPY GUS	✓ KIND COACH
ATTACKS YOUR IDENTITY "You ARE bad."	TALKS ABOUT YOUR BEHAVIOR "Oops — try again."
BIG & CATASTROPHIC "You ALWAYS mess up." "You'll NEVER get it right."	SPECIFIC · HONEST · KIND "What can I learn?" "What is one next step?"
POINTS TOWARD Hiding & shame	POINTS TOWARD Repair & growth

THE KIND COACH ASKS THREE QUESTIONS

1

What happened?

2

What can I learn?

3

What is one next step?

TEACHER NOTE

Color-code red/green when building with students. Post permanently. Reference every lesson for the rest of the year.

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 1 · LESSON 4

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

UNIT 1 · KNOWING & ACCEPTING YOURSELF · AUG-OCT

My Inside Voice — Kind or Unkind?

CUT VERTICALLY · LAMINATE · REUSE

SCENARIO · 1-G

My Inside Voice — Kind or Unkind?

THE SITUATION

Priya just got a spelling test back and missed 3 words. Her inside voice said, “See? You’re terrible at spelling. You’ll never get it right.”

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- ▶ Is that the Kind Coach or Grumpy Gus talking?
- ▶ Is “you’ll NEVER get it right” true?
- ▶ What would the Kind Coach say instead?

SCENARIO · 1-H

My Inside Voice — Kind or Unkind?

THE SITUATION

At PE, Marcus tripped and fell during the relay race. His inside voice said, “Everybody is laughing at you. You are the worst at PE.”

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- ▶ Is Grumpy Gus attacking Marcus’s BEHAVIOR or WHO HE IS?
- ▶ What are the Three Kind Coach Questions? (What happened? What can I learn? What is one next step?)
- ▶ What would the Kind Coach say to Marcus?

D R A W I N G E X A M P L E · U N I T 1 · L E S S O N
4

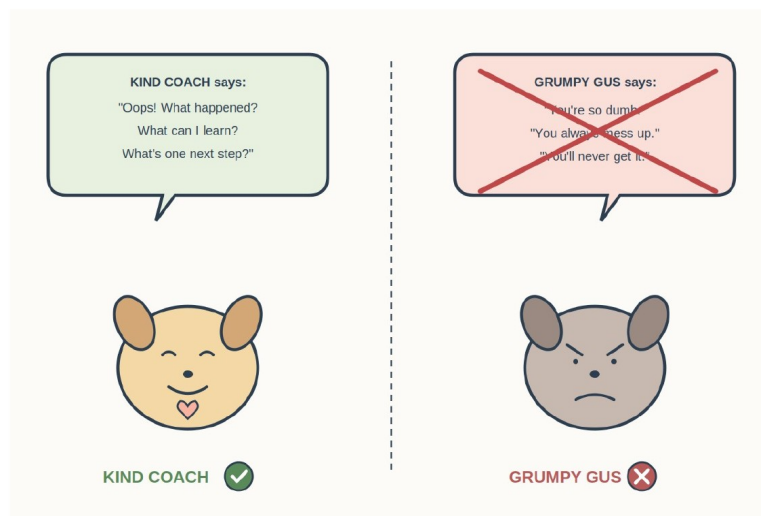
Visual reference for the drawing activity

DRAWING EXAMPLES · TEACHER REFERENCE

UNIT 1 · LESSON 4 · DRAWING EXAMPLE 4

KIND COACH SPEECH BUBBLE

Students draw Sammy the puppet (or a character of their choice) with a speech bubble showing what the KIND COACH would say.



HOW TO DRAW IT

- ▶ Draw Sammy (or your own character) looking kind and supportive.
- ▶ In the speech bubble, write what the KIND COACH would say after a mistake. Example: "Oops! What happened? What can I learn? What's one next step?"
- ▶ Next to it, draw Grumpy Gus saying something unkind — then cross it out with a red X.
- ▶ Label your drawing: KIND COACH ✓ and GRUMPY GUS ✗

TEACHER NOTE

Students may draw their own Kind Coach character — it doesn't have to be Sammy. The key is showing the contrast. Display with the anchor chart.

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE

This is a free preview.

Sample Lesson · Book 1 · The Foundation (K–2)

The complete, classroom-ready curriculum — with anchor charts, worksheets, Illinois SEL alignment, and scripted Direct Instruction — is part of the Architecture of Grace district library. Educators can license the full set; families can find materials in the family store.

architectureofgrace.org